

DESIGN DIRECTION

Website Redesign Brief

A consulting-firm inspired approach to position RFC as South Africa's leading food safety compliance partner. This document presents the design direction, key features, and strategic rationale.

OVERVIEW

Why This Direction

While the original brief outlined specific requirements, this design takes a different route — one that aligns RFC with the world's top consulting firms. The goal is immediate credibility. When a food safety manager, QA director, or business owner lands on this site, they should know within three seconds that RFC is a serious, established, professional organisation.

This is a concept showcase, not a final product. It demonstrates what is possible and serves as inspiration for the direction we recommend. All features shown are fully buildable and can be customised to your exact requirements.

DESIGN RESEARCH

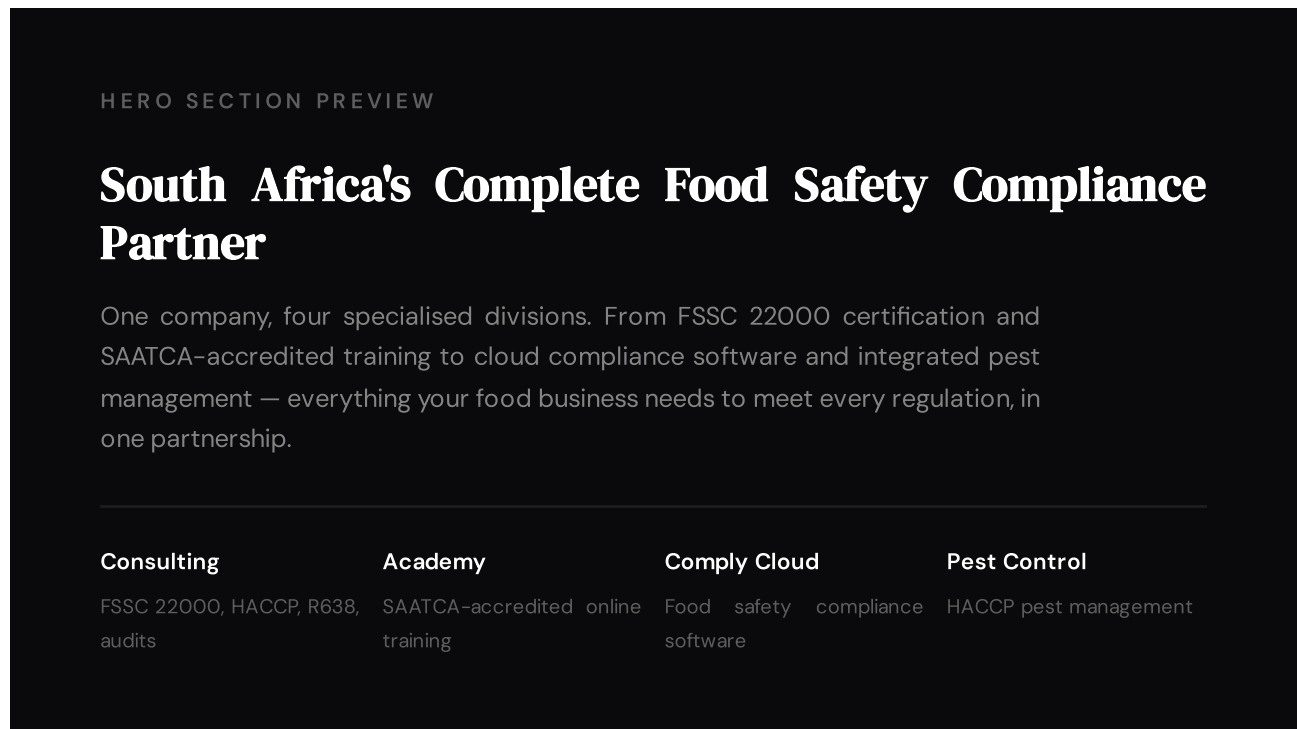
We analysed the digital presence of leading global consulting firms — **Bain & Company**, **BCG**, and **Deloitte** — to identify patterns that communicate authority and trust. Key findings:

- **No generic stat counters** — impact is shown through client stories, not "500+ clients" badges
- **Full-screen hero with motion** — video or dynamic backgrounds create immediate gravitas
- **Massive serif headlines** — editorial typography signals thought leadership
- **Thin rule separators, not cards** — clean lines replace boxy layouts
- **Contextual metrics** — numbers embedded in narratives, not isolated

THE HOMEPAGE HERO

Immediate Clarity on Who RFC Is

The hero section is the most critical part of any website. Within the first three seconds, a visitor must understand what the company does, who it serves, and why they should care. This design achieves that.



WHAT THE HERO COMMUNICATES

- **Geography & tenure:** "South Africa · Since 2013" — instant credibility
- **Complete solution:** "One company, four specialised divisions" — no competitor offers this
- **Every standard covered:** FSSC 22000, HACCP, R638, BRCGS, GLOBALG.A.P. — speaks the client's language
- **Four interactive division cards** — visitors can immediately navigate to their area of interest
- **Expertise capability bar** — reinforces technical depth (pattern from Bain & Company)

VISUAL TREATMENT

A looping video background of a professional food facility creates atmosphere and immediate visual authority. Multiple gradient overlays ensure text remains perfectly readable. The overall palette is dark, refined, and confident — green used only as an accent, never as a background.

INTERACTIVE FEATURES

Three Add-On Value Drivers

Beyond the design, three interactive features add measurable business value — each designed to capture leads, demonstrate expertise, and streamline the client journey.

FEATURE 01

CALENDAR BOOKING SYSTEM

A professional appointment scheduler showing available and booked dates per division. Clients select their division, choose an open slot, and book instantly. Eliminates back-and-forth emails. Each division can have its own availability calendar.

FEATURE 02

AUDIT READINESS QUIZ

A free 10-question assessment that scores a business's audit preparedness. Provides instant results with actionable recommendations. Positions RFC as a helpful expert before any sales conversation begins. Can be tailored per division.

FEATURE 03

AI CHAT ASSISTANT

A trained AI assistant embedded on every page. Fed with RFC's business knowledge — services, standards, pricing guidance, booking help. Handles enquiries 24/7, qualifies leads, and directs visitors to the right division or booking flow.

CALENDAR BOOKING

The booking system is built around division-specific availability. Each division — Consulting, Academy, Comply Cloud, Pest Control — can maintain its own calendar. Days are visually marked as available, limited, or fully booked. Clients complete a short form specifying their need, and the system confirms the appointment with calendar invites sent to both parties.

AUDIT READINESS QUIZ

The quiz serves as a "free assessment" lead magnet. Ten targeted questions evaluate a business across documentation, training, HACCP implementation, and facility standards. The result places them in one of four tiers — from "Critical Gaps" to "Audit Ready" — with specific next steps and a direct link to book a consultation. Different divisions can have entirely different quiz flows.

AI CHAT ASSISTANT

This is not a generic chatbot. It is trained specifically on RFC's services, standards, processes, and pricing structure. It can answer questions about FSSC 22000 requirements, explain the difference between R638 and HACCP, help visitors choose the right training course, and even initiate a booking. It captures lead information when a human follow-up would add value.

SITE ARCHITECTURE

How the Site Flows

IMPACT

CASE STUDIES

Three contextual client stories with challenge/result narratives. Metrics embedded in real outcomes, not isolated counters.

DIVISIONS

FOUR INTEGRATED DIVISIONS

Numbered editorial list with descriptions. Each links to its respective service page or external site.

SECTORS

INDUSTRIES SERVED

Interactive sector explorer — Manufacturing, Retail, Hospitality, Agriculture, Export, Healthcare.

SERVICES

CONSULTING SERVICES

FSSC 22000, HACCP, BRCGS, GLOBALG.A.P., R638, Internal Audits — each with detail pages.

SOFTWARE

COMPLY CLOUD

Dedicated section for the cloud compliance platform with demo booking and feature highlights.

TRAINING

RFC ACADEMY

Showcase of SAATCA-accredited courses with direct links to the learning platform.

ADDITIONAL PAGES

- **Blog** — SEO-optimised articles on food safety standards, compliance updates, and industry news
- **Contact** — Multi-channel contact with division-specific routing
- **Book Consultation** — Full calendar booking flow with division selection
- **Audit Quiz** — Standalone assessment tool with shareable results

The Design System

Every visual choice is deliberate. The system prioritises readability, professionalism, and credibility — the three qualities that convert visitors into clients.

TYPOGRAPHY

DM Serif Display for all major headings — an elegant, authoritative serif that signals editorial credibility. **DM Sans** for body text and UI elements — clean, modern, highly readable at all sizes. This pairing is used by boutique consulting firms and design-forward brands.

COLOUR PALETTE

Near-black (**#0a0a0c**) for hero and dark sections. Pure white for content areas. A single accent green (**#4a7c2f**) for labels, links, and highlights. Muted grays for secondary text. No gradients, no neon, no decorative colours — restraint signals confidence.

ICONS

Google Material Symbols in outlined style — the standard for modern professional interfaces. Consistent weight, consistent sizing, no decorative iconography. Every icon serves a functional purpose.

LAYOUT PRINCIPLES

- **No card shadows, no rounded corners** — sharp edges signal precision
- **Thin 1px rules** separate sections instead of background colour bands
- **Ample whitespace** — content breathes, every element has purpose
- **Asymmetric grids** — editorial layouts (sidebar + content) break visual monotony
- **No generic stock photography** — video and purposeful imagery only

SUMMARY

What This Website Will Do

This is not just a website. It is a business development tool designed to position RFC as the authority in South African food safety compliance.

Remember: This is a concept to demonstrate what is possible. Every element — colours, layouts, features — can be refined to your exact vision. The structure and strategic thinking are what matter most.

BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- **Immediate credibility** — visitors know RFC is a serious, established firm within 3 seconds
- **Lead generation** — booking system, quiz, and chatbot capture enquiries 24/7
- **Clear division navigation** — each of the four divisions has distinct, clear pathways
- **SEO foundation** — blog, structured content, and technical optimisation for organic discovery
- **Competitive differentiation** — no competitor in the South African market presents this level of professionalism

NEXT STEPS

This concept is ready for review. Upon approval, the full website can be built with your exact content, branding refinements, and any feature additions. The calendar system, quiz engine, and AI chatbot are all fully implementable and can be launched incrementally.